



SAINT LOUIS  
UNIVERSITY

— EST. 1818 —

Department of Chemistry  
Monsanto Hall

3501 Laclede Avenue  
St. Louis, MO 63103  
Phone: (314) 977-8567  
Fax: (314) 977-2521  
chemistry.slu.edu

**Brent M. Znosko, PhD**  
*Professor of Chemistry*  
*Undergraduate Program Coordinator*

April 12, 2022

**Re: Md. Sharear Saon, participant in CUTS**

To Whom It May Concern,

I have known Md. Sharear Saon for the past five years. He is a chemistry graduate student working in my lab. In the Fall of 2021, Sharear asked me to serve as his CUTS mentor. This letter summarizes our interactions related to his final portfolio.

At our initial meeting, Sharear and I discussed his career goals, his goals for pursuing the Certificate in University Teaching Skills, and the types of pedagogies that are most common in chemistry. After our first meeting, Sharear prepared a draft of his teaching philosophy. I read this draft and prepared feedback on the draft. At our second meeting, we reviewed his teaching philosophy draft, both on content and form. Sharear taught a lecture for CHEM 4610: Biochemistry 1, a class normally taught by my colleague Dr. Dana Baum. During this lecture, Sharear reviewed material that would be covered in an upcoming exam. Original PowerPoint slides were provided by Dr. Baum, Sharear modified the slides slightly, added some interactive exercises, taught the class, and recorded the class. I watched the class live, re-watched the recording, and completed the Faculty Mentor Feedback form. At our third meeting, we discussed Sharear's teaching. Although he did not have too much freedom with the content, he did a great job reviewing the material. He interacted with the students and kept them engaged. He presented well, knew the material, and was confident. Most recently, Sharear provided me a web link to a draft of his teaching portfolio. I read through his portfolio and prepared feedback. I had already seen much of the material and had already provided feedback. During our fourth meeting, we discussed his teaching portfolio. I provided feedback on the portfolio page as well as his sample syllabus (which I hadn't seen before). Overall, all of the meetings during this process were productive; our meetings were conversational about the topic of the meeting and of teaching in general.

Based on my interactions with Sharear during our meetings and the materials that he prepared for his portfolio, I feel that Sharear deserves to receive the Reinert Center's Certificate in University Teaching Skills.

If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,

